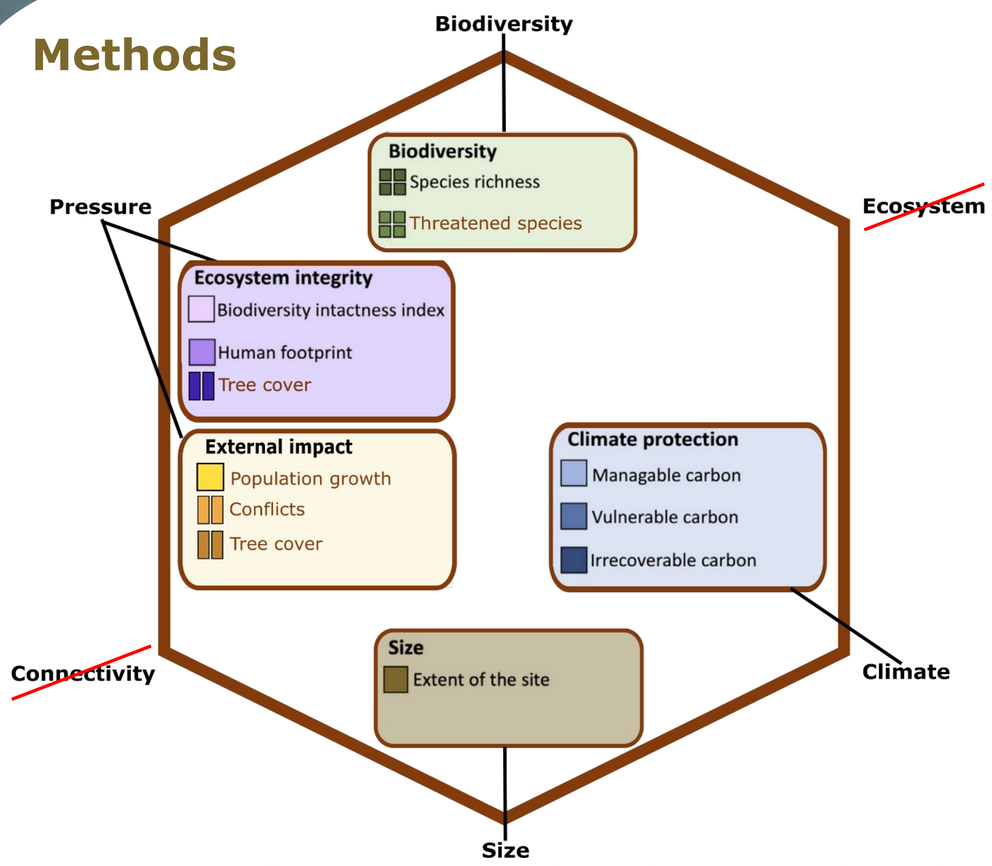
SENCKENBERG
NATURE RESEARCH

Protected Areas in Focus: Tracking Progress Toward Sustainability Goals

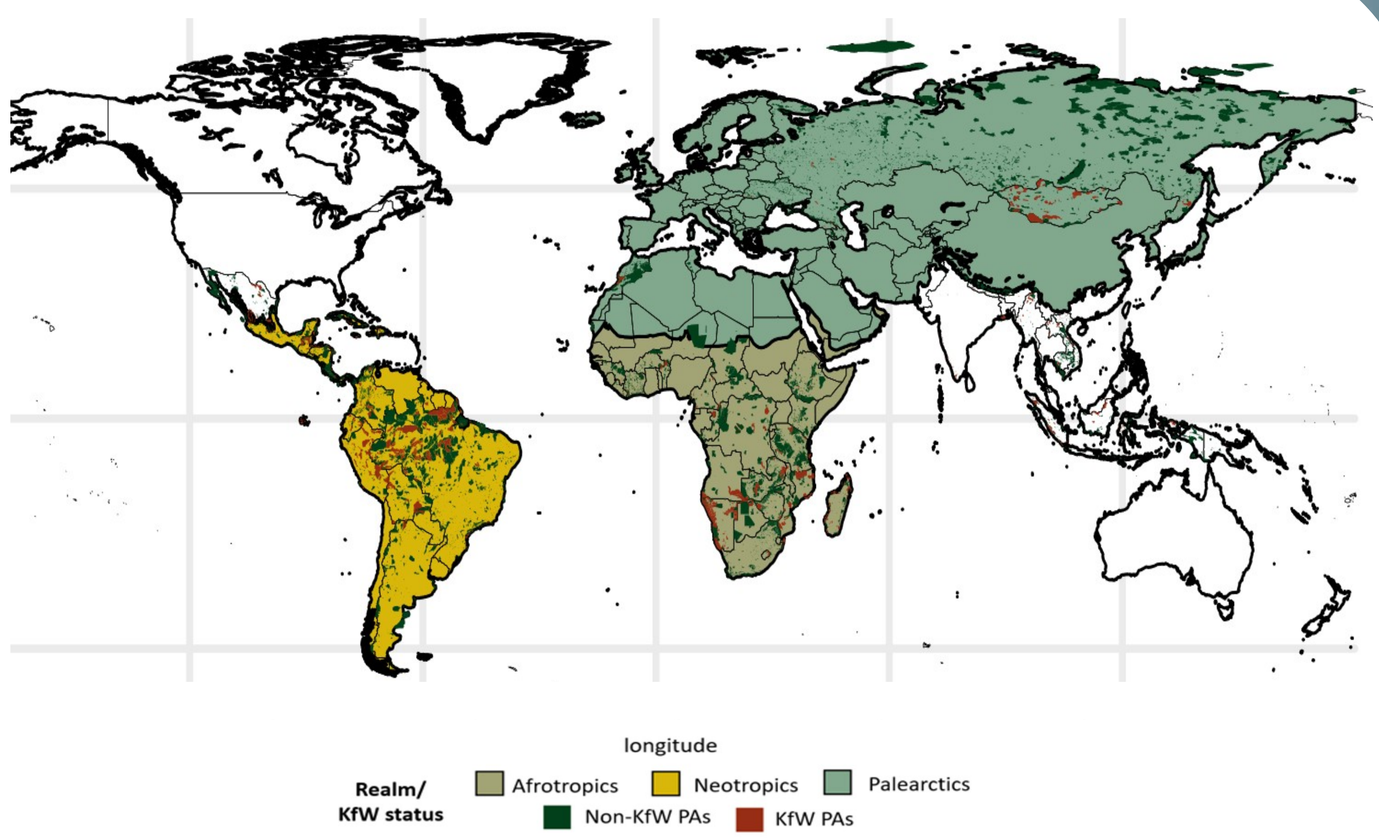
Sofiia Klimovych, Dr. Alke Voskamp, Dr. Johannes Schielein, Dr. Timo Schönfeldt

Challenge: Limited conservation funding poses a challenge for prioritizing protected areas. This research addresses that challenge by evaluating how individual sites and networks contribute to global biodiversity and climate goals, to inform more strategic funding decisions

Methods

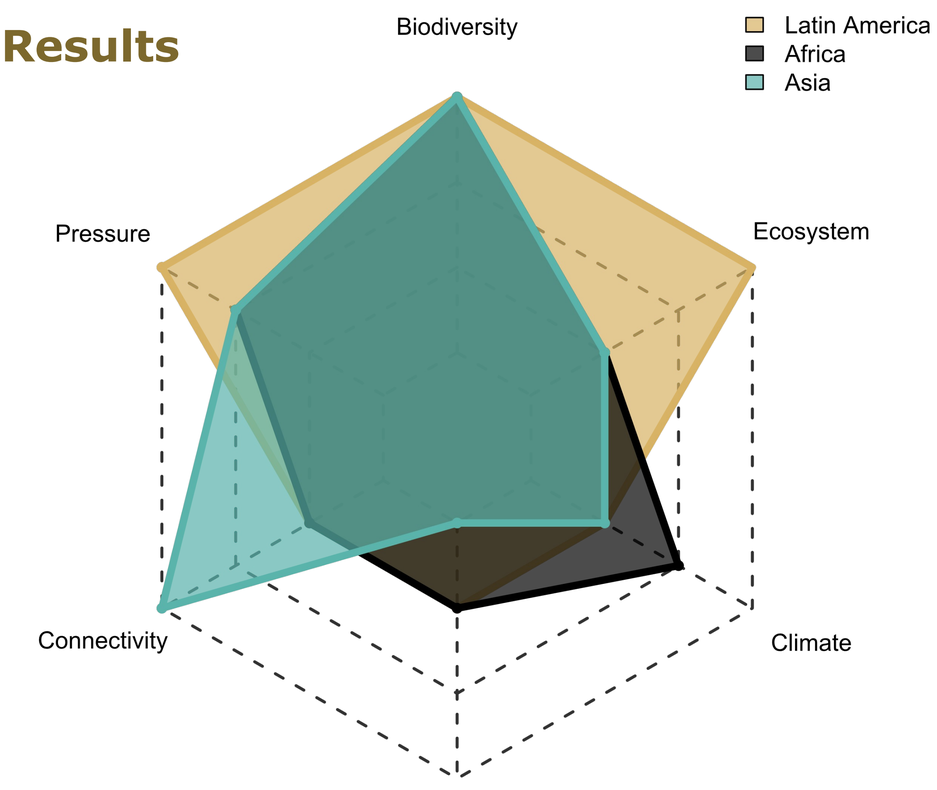


Relevant global frameworks were investigated, and interviews with KfW representatives were conducted to develop appropriate nature protection objectives and matching indicators. The objectives and indicators enabled the quantification of individual sites' contributions to global nature and climate goals, based on globally available datasets*.

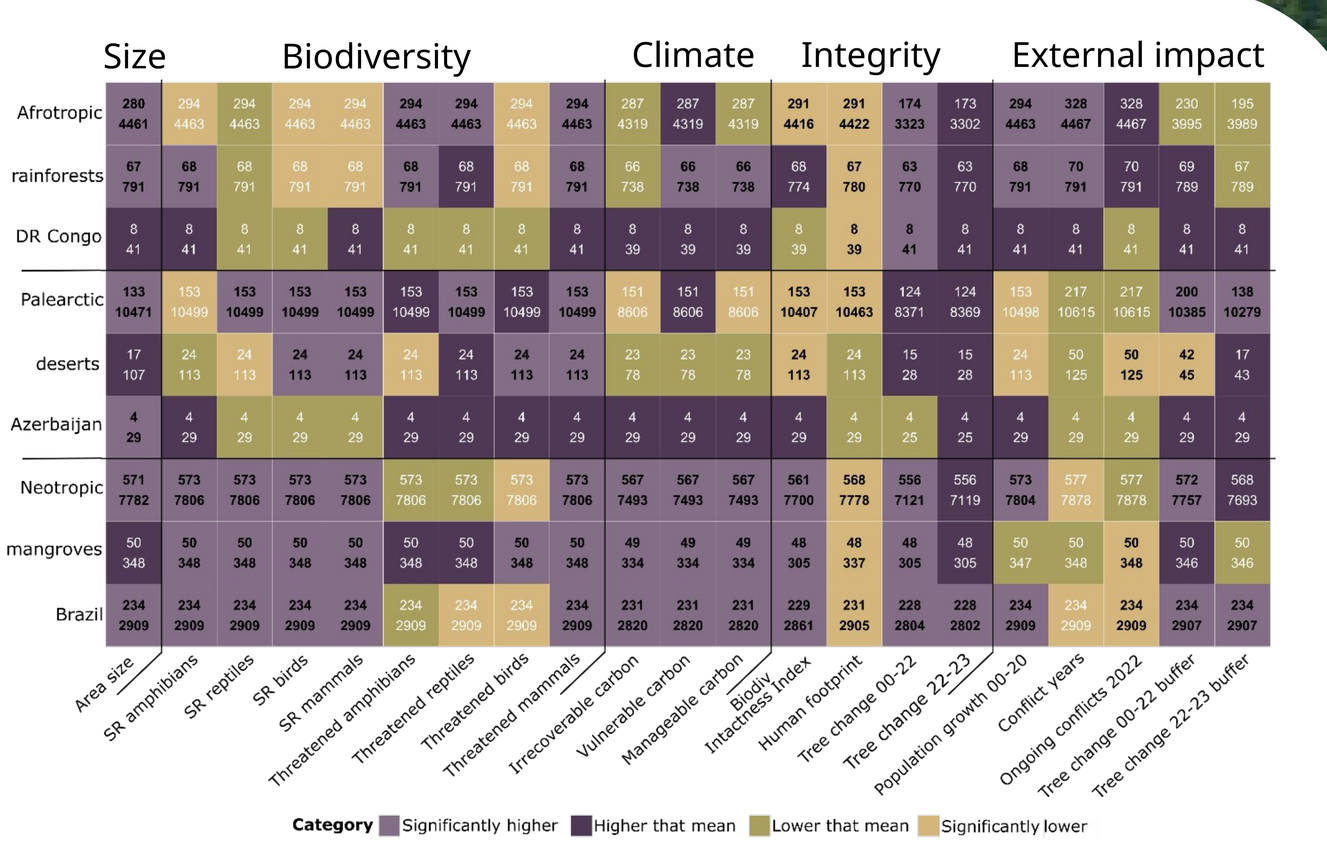


In 2022, the KfW supported 1,050 non-marine protected areas across 72 ODA countries. To quantify each site's and network's contribution to global climate and biodiversity goals, data were analyzed at regional, country, and biogeographic realm scales. The map highlights three example realms used to develop a statistical framework for assessing the PA portfolio at multiple spatial levels.

Results



Biodiversity played an important role in the selection process across all regions. The highest number of criteria was considered in Latin America.



The 2022 KfW PA network's contribution to global nature and climate goals was evaluated. Performance was strongest in the Neotropics, especially Brazil. Overall, results improved at larger spatial scales, with Brazil as a notable exception at the country level.

Conclusion: With limited funding, protected area selection must balance ecological value and strategic impact. Site and network-level contributions to global biodiversity and climate goals offer a useful criterion for guiding funding decisions and evaluating existing PA portfolios.

Outlook: The developed framework can be expanded to incorporate additional protected area datasets and integrate further ecological and socio-economic variables, enabling broader and more comprehensive evaluations in the future.

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